



recycling).

value in (whether for reuse or

from the waste what one sees

Waste picking is about pulling

is a kind of “waste picking.”

This act of salvage and reuse

• Sharps container

• Bag for unusable trash and
a place to dispose of it

• Bag for recyclables

Nice to have:

Pick up things with your grabber to avoid touching biohazards, like rotting food and used needles. Make sure your plastic bags are water tight so any water in the textiles doesn't leak.



Before you get started, make sure it's ok to take those items.

• Plastic bags

• Grabber/reacher tool

• Gloves

(it's color safe!)

• Big tub of OxiClean

• Laundry detergent

• Washing machine & dryer

What you'll need:

community abundance.

items back into use, and share

neighborhood, bring those

You can clean up your

useable. Waste not, want not.

road and some of it looks

and/or linens on the side of the

So you found a pile of clothing

While it's great to harvest abandoned materials, make sure they are truly abandoned. Do not take things next to an active campsite. You could be stealing from someone's home.

If you encounter a camper, introduce yourself and tell them what you are doing. Usually they will think it's cool, but if they ask you to leave, leave.

If you find a cache of stuff that looks organized or has a sleeping bag with it, someone may be coming back for it. Observe for a few days before removing the items.



CLEANING YOUR HAUL

- Empty pockets and remove large detritus like leaves and twigs
- Add detergent and a scoop of OxiClean
- Wash on the hottest/heaviest setting you have
- Do not overload your washing machine or dryer or it will be harder to get rid of stains and odors
- Don't attempt to work on items that are VERY stinky—there's nothing your regular washing machine can do about it, not even bleach will save them

• Churches

• Shelters

• Waste picker orgs

• Houseless outreach orgs

• School clothing closets

• Free stores

• Buy *Nothing* groups

PLACES TO SHARE YOUR HAUL

mendingbloc.carrd.co:



learn how!

zines to help you

Mending Bloc has

and replace zippers.

sew on on patches, cover stains,

If you're up for the challenge,

MENDING

- Once dry, sort out damaged items

WARNINGS ABOUT WOOL

Wool is an amazing material for clothing but it needs some special care. Washing in hot water will shrink and felt wool, so stick to cold water. Wool items must be washed immediately upon collection to prevent the spread of wool moths.

Finally, do not bother with the fragile wool blankets that are given to houseless folks. They are intended to degrade naturally and will destroy your washer and dryer.